

# ‘It looks like we are in Mussoorie or Ooty’

A reporter’s diary from Aichi-Nagoya 2026 captures the **unusual journey** to the Aichi Prefectural General Shooting Gallery, from hairpin bends and Buddhist temples to transport quirks.

**Jonathan Selvaraj**  
jonathan.selvaraj@thehindu.co.in

**T**he journey to the Aichi Prefectural General Shooting Gallery is a two-hour bus ride from Nagoya that takes you nearly 670m up into the highlands around Toyota City.

As journeys to sporting venues go, it’s as scenic as it gets. Palm trees, urban landscapes and busy shipyards give way to idyllic hills, rolling white clouds, thick forests of massive evergreen conifers, Buddhist temples, lakes, crystal-clear streams and quaint, sloped-roofed kominka farmhouses amid the odd rice field.

“It looks like we are in Mussoorie

or Ooty,” shooting coach Manoj Kumar says.

## **Altitude challenges**

But picturesque as it is, the journey comes with its own headache, quite literally. For athletes, there’s the distance to be travelled and the umpteen hairpin bends they have to navigate along the way.

Things you might usually do on a long journey, such as playing mobile games, browsing the internet, reading or watching videos, are forbidden. The concern is that staring at a bright screen while travelling along the winding roads might lead to nausea. Not what you want at the range.

Elavenil Valarivan said she listened to a playlist of English, Hindi and Tamil songs. She also carried a neck pillow to deal with any potential neck issues that might arise while

driving around the mountainside. While Elavenil came through the experience with two silver medals to show for it, not everyone was as lucky.

Vidarsa K Vinod, who won a silver in the team event, was seen getting a massage to her neck from a team physio at the end of the day.

## **Spectator journey**

Media persons don’t have to worry about such predicaments. The biggest issue on the first day at the range was a traffic jam caused by media and athlete vehicles halfway up the hill. This, in turn, forced an impromptu half-kilometre trek.

For spectators at the shooting events, the journey is a lot more challenging. While media persons and sportspersons get direct buses from the press centre and designated hotels, fans have no such luck.

“It takes me three hours to get to

**Picturesque:** A rainbow arches over the Aichi Prefectural General Shooting Gallery ahead of the Asian Games shooting events near Toyota. R.V. MOORTHY

